

residents go beyond the surface. They get out of hotels and into people's homes. They visit the neighborhoods, meet the locals, and learn the language.

New residents try to find short-term apartments or apart-hotels rather than tourist hotels. That gives them a chance to cook the local fish and vegetables at "home." New residents read the English-language newspaper not so much for international news but to find out what social events they might enjoy. They visit the American Club, the American library, and the University Women's Club. They travel with their hobbies. They take cooking classes or golf lessons, even for short periods. They take time to figure out the buses and trains rather than take cabs everywhere. They order what others are eating in restaurants rather than choose from a menu in English. They buy, rather than stare, in the fruit and meat markets.

New residents telephone people on the list they brought from home. In 1985 Vicki and I spent a month in Madrid. During the first week we called three of the four names on our "contacts" list. One invited us to play bridge, another to a jazz club, and a third to a bullfight. They introduced us to their friends and gave us advice on what to do and see. Some went so far as to laugh at my jokes.

WHERE WE'VE LIVED

Here, following, are short, selected comments on some of the countries Vicki and I have visited since retiring four years ago. We "lived like a resident" for at least a month in each of them. My comments show bias and personal preference based on what we found. I focus on feelings and impressions rather than on the facts you can get in a tourist guide.

Before we get started, there are three preliminaries. First, Vicki and I prefer hot weather. All the countries I discuss have warm climates during part of the year. But for those who hate to sweat, most have cooler periods as well. Mexico's Yucatán peninsula stays warm, or even hot, virtually year-round. But in Oaxaca, over five thousand feet up in the